

CloudFlow Support Escalation Procedures Manual

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Classification: Internal Use Only

1. Escalation Tiers

Tier 1 - Frontline Support: Handles password resets, basic how-to questions, and known issues with documented solutions.

Target resolution: under 10 minutes.

Tier 2 - Technical Support: Handles API errors, integration issues, performance problems, and configuration troubleshooting.

Target resolution: under 2 hours.

Tier 3 - Engineering Escalation: Handles infrastructure outages, security incidents, data corruption, and bugs requiring code changes.

Target resolution: under 24 hours.

Tier 4 - Management Escalation: Handles billing disputes, legal requests, executive complaints, and SLA breach situations.

Target resolution: under 4 hours.

2. Mandatory Escalation Triggers

The following situations REQUIRE immediate escalation to Tier 3+4:

- Any mention of data breach or unauthorized access
- Account compromise or suspected fraud
- Service outage affecting multiple customers
- Legal threats or regulatory compliance issues
- Billing disputes over \$500
- Customer has attempted resolution 3+ times without success
- VIP or Enterprise customer expressing dissatisfaction
- Any request to speak with management

3. Handoff Protocol

When escalating, the agent MUST include:

1. Customer persona classification
2. Complete conversation history
3. All troubleshooting steps already attempted
4. Relevant knowledge base articles referenced
5. Customer account information and plan tier
6. Recommended next steps based on analysis

The handoff summary should be formatted as structured JSON to enable automated routing and tracking.

4. SLA Requirements

Enterprise Plan: 15-minute response, 1-hour resolution target

Professional Plan: 1-hour response, 4-hour resolution target

Free Plan: 24-hour response, 48-hour resolution target

SLA breaches must be reported to the Support Manager within 30 minutes of detection.

5. Communication Guidelines by Persona

Technical Expert: Provide detailed technical information. Reference error codes, API docs, and system architecture. Skip basic explanations.

Frustrated User: Lead with empathy. Use simple language. Provide step-by-step instructions. Follow up to confirm resolution.

Business Executive: Focus on business impact and timelines. Be concise. Avoid technical jargon. Provide clear action items and ETAs.